You said:

how much is a Gatekeeper subscription?

ChatGPT said:

Gatekeeper (GatekeeperHQ), the contract and vendor management platform, currently uses custom subscription pricing and does not publish official prices.

However, third-party pricing information gives us a useful indication of its cost.

Estimated Gatekeeper subscription costs

Plan	USD/month	AED/month (approx.)
Essentials (older plan)	$1,245	AED 4,572
Pro	$2,995	AED 11,000
Enterprise	$5,295	AED 19,448

These are **historically reported prices**, not confirmed quotations for Gatekeeper's current plans.

Features & ... +1

Current plans (October 2026)

Gatekeeper now advertises three tiers:

- **Pro:** Up to 250 third parties.
- **Enterprise:** Up to 750 third parties.
- **Enterprise Plus:** More than 750 third parties.

All include unlimited users, unlimited contracts, electronic signatures, AI features and workflow automation. Pricing depends on supplier volume, workflows and integrations.

Gatekeeper

You can request a quotation on the official Gatekeeper pricing page ↗.

What this means for your dashboard projects

For your Commercial Operations Dashboard or Operations Workspace, Gatekeeper is an interesting benchmark because it combines supplier management, contracts, compliance, workflows and financial reporting.

One independent pricing benchmark reports a median annual contract of approximately **$39,240 (AED 144,100)**, although this is based on only five reported purchases.

CostBench

This is a relatively expensive enterprise platform, which makes it useful to study both its functionality and how it justifies its subscription pricing.

Are you looking at Gatekeeper as a **potential subscription for Cognita**, or primarily as a **competitor/reference for developing your own dashboard**? That distinction would change how I'd evaluate its value.

You said:

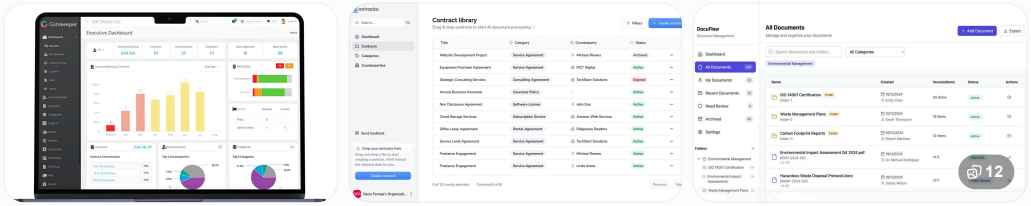
i want to create a much more limited and smaller customized similar platform. is it possible? not for competing in the market, but for personal business use - documentation and keeping data and filing purposes.

ChatGPT said:

Yes. In fact, I think building a **smaller, customized version of Gatekeeper for your own business use** is entirely feasible, and potentially much more practical than subscribing to a large enterprise platform.

You don't need most of Gatekeeper's advanced features. What you need is a **centralized commercial operations and documentation platform** where you can organize information, retrieve documents, monitor contracts, and track your work.

1. What your platform could look like



Visual references for the type of interface we could build, rather than an exact copy of Gatekeeper.

I would organize the platform into six core modules.

1. Suppliers & Partners

A central register of suppliers, contact details, services provided, associated schools/business units, important documents and related contracts.

2. Contracts Management

Store agreements, addendums and side letters; record contract dates, fees, renewal terms, expiry dates and important obligations.

3. Documents & Filing

A searchable digital filing system for contracts, quotations, insurance certificates, licenses, correspondence, SOPs and other documents.

4. Tasks & Follow-ups

Keep track of actions, outstanding documents, contract renewals, supplier issues, deadlines and reminders.

5. Commercial Data

Record commissions, revenue, payment schedules, supplier financial arrangements and performance data. This could later connect with your existing commercial dashboard.

6. Overview Dashboard

A homepage showing active contracts, upcoming expiries, outstanding tasks, missing documentation and important updates.

2. The most important design principle: connected information

Rather than creating six isolated sections, I would design everything around a common data structure.

For example, when you open a supplier, you should be able to see all its related information in one place.

Supplier Profile — Example

Central record

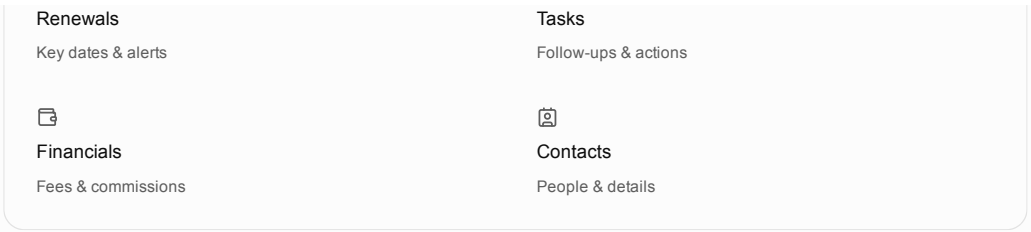
Active

Contracts

Agreements & terms

Documents

Certificates & files



This means that a document could be linked to a supplier, a contract, and a school without uploading three separate copies.

3. How I would build it

Given your existing experience with React, Supabase, GitHub and Vercel, we could use a familiar architecture.

Layer	Recommended technology
Frontend	React + Tailwind CSS
Database	Supabase PostgreSQL
Document storage	Supabase Storage
Authentication	Supabase Auth
Hosting	Vercel
Source control	GitHub
Reminders	Scheduled server-side jobs, later

For a personal-use platform with relatively modest storage and traffic, infrastructure costs could be very low, potentially within free tiers initially. Paid services may become necessary for storage, backups or production reliability.

Importantly, **we should build it using independent, reusable components**, so that changing the Contracts page doesn't accidentally modify Suppliers, Tasks or the overall dashboard.

4. What I would deliberately exclude

At least initially, I would avoid complex approval workflows, electronic signatures, AI contract analysis, ERP integrations, supplier self-service portals and elaborate permissions systems.

Those are expensive to develop and maintain, and unnecessary for a personal documentation platform.

Instead, I would focus on three qualities: **fast data entry, excellent search, and easy retrieval of information**.

5. One architectural decision worth making early

I would not automatically build this as another module inside your Commercial Operations Dashboard.

There is a case for making it a **separate, lightweight Business Management Workspace** that can eventually integrate with your other systems.

This keeps its purpose clear and avoids turning one dashboard into an oversized application.

One question before we design it

When you say *personal business use*, which of these best describes your intention?

- (●) **My own work at Cognita** — managing suppliers, contracts, documents, commercial information and tasks across schools.
- ( ) **My own independent business activities** — a general-purpose workspace for various projects and businesses.
- ( ) **Both** — one platform capable of handling separate organizations or workspaces.

Continue with this scope →

That choice will determine how we structure the database, documents, organizations and access controls from the beginning.

You said:

Cognita will have a licensed Gatekeeper account. i want to have a similar structure for my own use.

ChatGPT said:

That clarifies the objective considerably.

Since **Cognita will already have a licensed Gatekeeper account**, there is no reason for us to recreate its full enterprise functionality.

Instead, I would propose building your own **lightweight, Gatekeeper-inspired management platform**, primarily for organizing your work, maintaining records, filing documents and retrieving information.

The distinction is important:

- **Gatekeeper:** Cognita's official system for contract and supplier management, governance, approvals and compliance.
- **Your platform:** Your personal operational workspace, where you can organize the suppliers, contracts, projects, documents, commercial arrangements and follow-ups relevant to your responsibilities.

Your platform would complement Gatekeeper rather than replace it.

How I would structure it

I would make **Suppliers, Contracts, Documents and Activities** the core of the platform, with everything linked together.

For example, a supplier record would connect to its contracts, supporting documentation, associated schools, financial arrangements and outstanding actions.

That way, you can navigate from a supplier to its contracts, or from a contract to its related documents, without searching through folders or spreadsheets.

I would also keep the architecture modular so that we can design and improve individual sections independently without affecting unrelated features.

The structure we can borrow from Gatekeeper

Gatekeeper's official documentation describes a core model built around vendors, contracts, entities, teams and categories, with relationships between records. That's a very good starting point for our smaller system.

Gatekeeper … +1

Gatekeeper concept	Your customized version
Vendors	Suppliers and service providers
Entities	Cognita schools / business units
Categories	Catering, Uniform, Transport, Leasing, etc.
Contracts	Agreements, addendums, side letters
Files Repository	Organized documents and attachments
Workflows	Simple tasks, reminders and follow-ups
Reporting	Personal operational overview

One important consideration: because this involves Cognita information, we should establish what data you're authorized to store outside its approved systems. Ideally, Gatekeeper remains the official repository, while your workspace stores permitted metadata, references, links and personal work tracking. Confidential contracts or supplier information should only be copied into separately hosted storage if Cognita approves it.

My suggested next step

I would start with the data architecture, not the visual design or coding.

First, define the records we need, their fields, and how they connect. Then design the individual pages and reusable components. This would also avoid the problem you've experienced in previous dashboard development, where unrelated features changed during updates.

One thing I would like to establish: **do you want your platform to be mainly a structured filing and information-retrieval system, or should it also actively manage your day-to-day work, tasks and follow-ups?**

We can support both, but the distinction will help us keep the initial version appropriately small.

You said:

just forget about Cognita and what Cognita have and will do. I want to set up something that can capture the features of a platform similar to Gatekeeper, can you help with that?

Memory updated

ChatGPT said:

Yes, absolutely. We can build a smaller, customized platform inspired by Gatekeeper, incorporating many of its useful features without the complexity of a full enterprise solution.

We'll treat this as an **independent software project**, with no assumptions about any particular company or existing system.

1. What we can build

I suggest a modular **Contract & Vendor Management Platform**, combining document management, structured records, relationships, workflows and reporting.



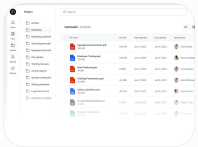
Vendor Management

Centralized vendor profiles, contact details, classifications, associated contracts, documents and status tracking.



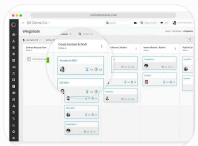
Contract Management

Contract register, key dates, values, obligations, amendments, renewals and related parties.



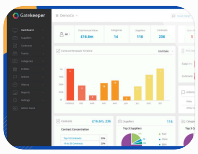
Document Management

File uploads, organized folders, document categories, searchable metadata, version history and linked records.



Workflow & Task Management

Tasks, checklists, status tracking, reminders, activities and simple approval stages where needed.



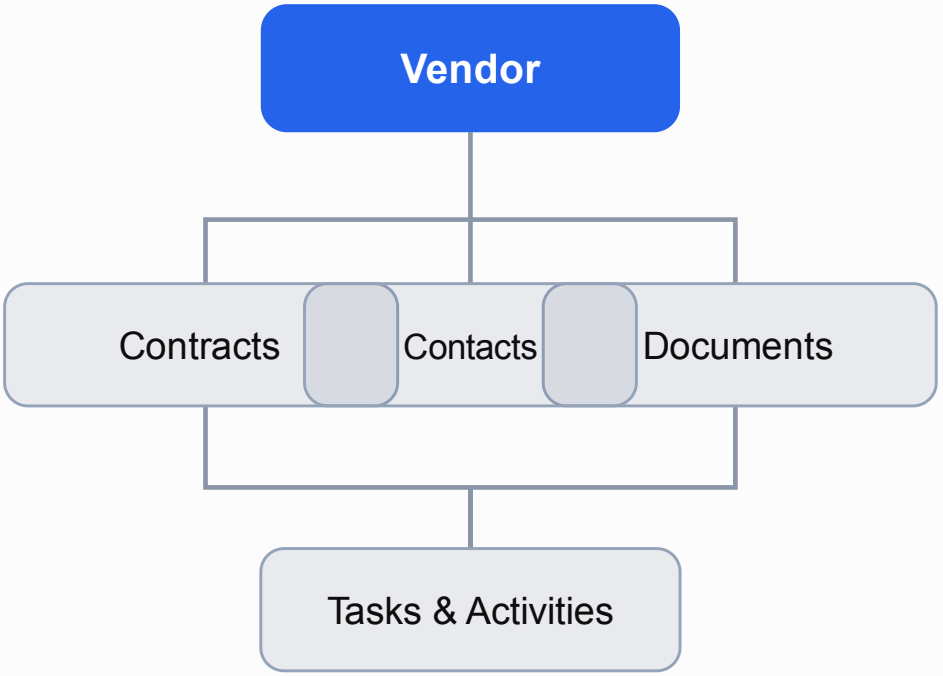
Dashboard & Reporting

Contract summaries, upcoming expirations, vendor statistics, outstanding tasks and customizable views.

2. How the platform should work

The most important feature isn't the dashboard itself. It's the **relationships between records**.

Example: Connected data structure



One record connects to multiple modules, avoiding duplicate data entry.

For example, a contract would have its own profile, linked vendor, uploaded documents, amendments, renewal dates, financial terms and activity history.

3. Architecture and development approach

I recommend:

- **React + TypeScript:** Frontend and reusable UI components.
- **Supabase:** PostgreSQL database, authentication and file storage.
- **Vercel:** Hosting.
- **GitHub:** Version control and controlled development.
- **Modular architecture:** Each feature built and updated independently.

We should create a shared design system, reusable components, and clearly defined module boundaries before developing the individual pages.

4. Development roadmap

Phase 1 — Foundation

Database architecture, navigation, reusable UI components, authentication and record relationships.

Phase 2 — Core Modules

Vendors, contracts, documents, contacts, categories and searchable registers.

Phase 3 — Operational Features

Tasks, activities, reminders, contract milestones and basic workflows.

Phase 4 — Advanced Features

Dashboards, custom fields, reporting, document versioning and optional automation.

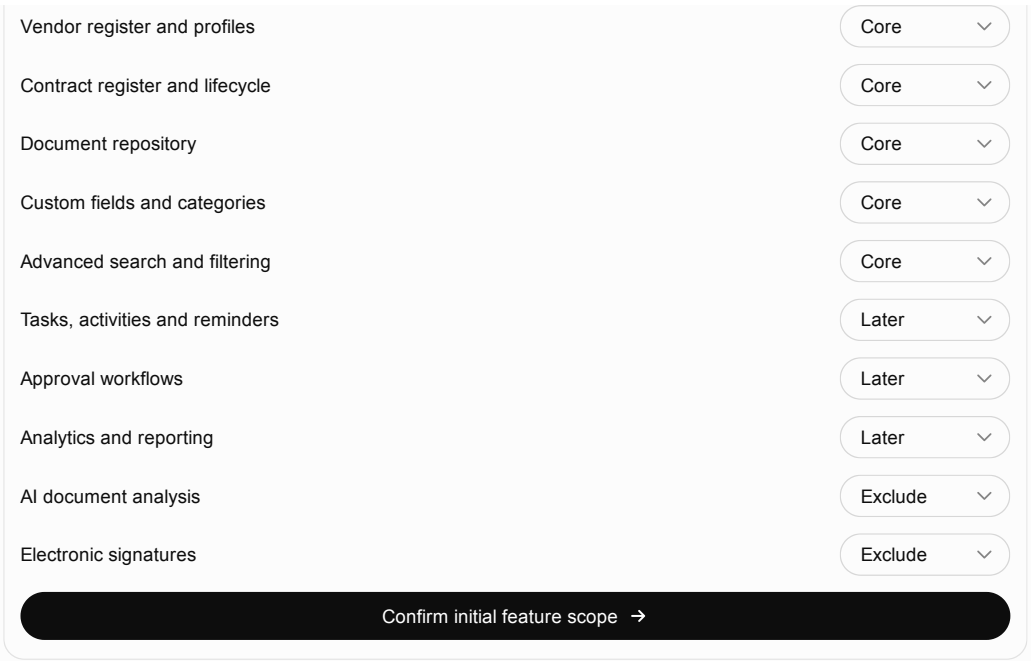
5. My proposed starting point

Rather than immediately coding, I suggest we first **study Gatekeeper's structure and features systematically**, identify which ones are useful, and create our own feature specification.

We can classify each feature as:

Initial feature selection Editable

Priority



We don't need to finalize every feature now. The objective is to build a solid foundation that can grow gradually without repeatedly redesigning the entire application.

You said:

where does Gatekeeper keep its files and database?

ChatGPT said:

Gatekeeper is a cloud-based SaaS platform, meaning its customers' contracts, documents, supplier records and other data are stored on cloud infrastructure rather than on their own computers.

There are two distinct storage components:

1. **Database:** Structured information such as vendors, contracts, dates, financial terms, contacts, custom fields and workflow records.
2. **File storage:** Uploaded contracts, PDFs, certificates, attachments and supporting documents.

These are logically connected, so a contract record in the database can reference its associated documents in cloud storage.

Where exactly does Gatekeeper host its data?

Gatekeeper confirms that it uses **Amazon Web Services (AWS)** for hosting both its application and customer data.

gatekeeperh… +1

Its published regional hosting options include:

- United States
- Ireland / Europe
- Australia / Asia-Pacific
- Canada

Customers can choose a regional tenancy, subject to the available hosting options.

gatekeeperh… +1

Gatekeeper also documents AES-256 encryption for stored data, TLS encryption in transit, redundancy and backups.

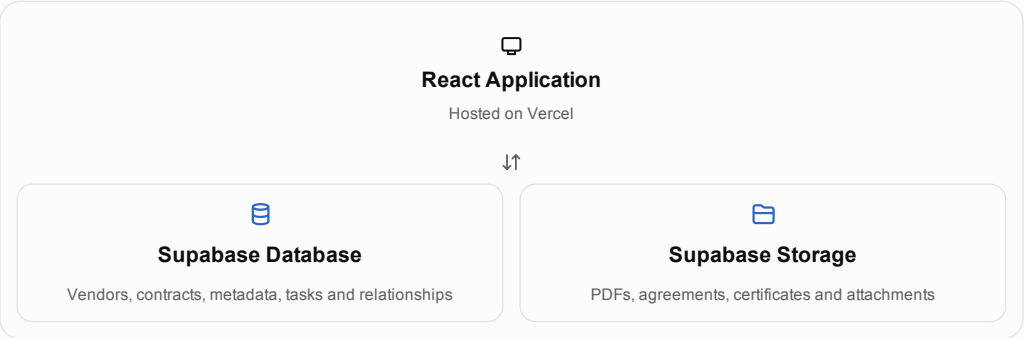
gatekeeperhq.c…

One technical detail is not publicly confirmed: **which specific AWS database engine and file-storage services Gatekeeper uses internally**. For example, we shouldn't assume it uses PostgreSQL and Amazon

S3 simply because it runs on AWS.

What I recommend for our platform

We can achieve a similar separation of data and documents using a simpler architecture:



This gives us centralized cloud storage, private file access, searchable records and the ability to scale later. We would also configure access policies, encryption and recoverable backups rather than relying on hosting alone.

My recommendation is to start with Supabase for both the database and document storage. We don't need the complexity of AWS infrastructure for a relatively small platform, and we can design the storage layer to support migration later.

You said:

does Supabase support storing documents? how much storage do they provide? should i have a separate cloud storage service like dropbox or onedrive or something else or does supabase (maybe paid tier) do the trick?

ChatGPT said:

Yes. Supabase can store documents, PDFs, Word files, Excel spreadsheets, images and other file types. For the Gatekeeper-inspired platform we're planning, I would recommend using **Supabase for both the database and document storage**, at least initially.

You don't necessarily need Dropbox, OneDrive or another separate cloud storage service.

The key is understanding that Supabase has two different services:

- **Supabase Database (PostgreSQL):** Stores vendor records, contract information, dates, metadata, relationships and document references.
- **Supabase Storage:** Stores the actual PDF, Word, Excel and other files, in private storage buckets.

When you open a contract in your application, Supabase retrieves its details from the database and gives authorized users access to its linked documents.

1. How much storage does Supabase provide?

These are the current published limits as of October 2026.

	Free	Pro
Monthly subscription	$0	$25 (~AED 92)
File storage included	1 GB	100 GB
Database included	500 MB	8 GB
Maximum individual file size	50 MB	Up to 500 GB*
Extra file storage	Not available	~$0.0213/GB/month
Database backups	Limited	Daily, 7-day retention
Inactivity pause	After 7 days	No

*The 500 GB figure is the configurable upper limit, not included storage. Practical upload methods and limits also apply.
Sources: Supabase +1 .

For a document management system, 100 GB is substantial.

Assuming an average document size of 2 MB:

10 GB	50 GB	100 GB
~5,000 documents	~25,000 documents	~50,000 documents

Even if you exceed the 100 GB included storage, the additional storage cost is relatively low.

Supabase Pro storage cost estimator

Total stored files **100 GB**

Estimated monthly total

$25.00

Approximately AED 92

Extra storage cost

$0.00

Illustrative estimate for one included Pro project, excluding additional compute, bandwidth, taxes and other usage charges. Assumes steady storage throughout the month.

2. Supabase vs OneDrive vs Dropbox

Capability	Supabase Storage	OneDrive / SharePoint	Dropbox
Upload and download through your application	Excellent	Via Microsoft Graph API	Via Dropbox API
Link files to database records	Native integration	Custom integration	Custom integration
Private file access	Yes	Yes	Yes
Familiar desktop file syncing	Not native	Yes	Yes
Edit Word/Excel online	Not native	Excellent	Via integrations
Automatic document versioning	Build or configure	Built-in	Built-in
Best use	Application backend	Office document collaboration	File syncing and sharing

The important distinction is that **Supabase Storage is not a traditional file management application** like OneDrive.

It provides the storage infrastructure. We would build the document management interface ourselves, including file browsing, search, previews, version history and download controls.

For our platform, that is actually an advantage because we can control the user experience.

3. How I would organize the documents

Rather than organizing everything through physical folders, I recommend a database-driven filing system.

Document Repository

- Contracts
  - Master Agreement.pdf
  - Amendment 01.pdf
- Vendor Documents
- Financial Records
- Correspondence

Each file also has searchable metadata

Vendor	Contract
Document type	Date uploaded
Expiry date	Tags

For example, you could search for all insurance certificates expiring in the next 60 days, regardless of which folders contain them.

This is one of the main advantages of a structured platform over ordinary cloud storage.

4. One thing I would insist on: independent backups

I would not rely exclusively on Supabase to preserve all your documents.

Supabase database backups do not automatically provide a complete backup of the actual files in Storage. We should implement a separate process for backing up documents and metadata.

For example:

- Primary database and document storage: Supabase.
- Periodic backup: separate storage such as OneDrive or an S3-compatible backup service.
- Ability to export the entire document repository and its metadata.

That provides additional protection against accidental deletion, application errors or account problems.

My recommendation

Start with Supabase Pro — $25/month

Use it as the single backend for your database, authentication and document storage. There is no need to pay for another cloud storage provider just to make the application work.

We can develop and test on the Free plan first, then move to Pro when the platform becomes operational.

I would also design the file-storage integration as an independent component, so that if we ever decide to move files to OneDrive, AWS S3 or another provider, we won't have to redesign the entire platform.

One question that affects our architecture: Do you want to be able to open a Word or Excel document directly from the platform, edit it in Microsoft Office, and save the updated version back to the platform?

That is where OneDrive/SharePoint integration might offer a real advantage over using Supabase Storage alone.